*Temporary minimum lane widths are not to be greater than existing lane widths. This minimum temporary lane width does not apply to curves of radius 250 m or less, or locations where there are fixed vertical obstructions such as fences or safety barriers within 30 cm of the edge of the lane on one or both sides. Where these conditions apply, consider widths wider than those listed previously to accommodate large vehicles. The speed to be used when considering lane width requirements is the speed limit (permanent or reduced) which is applicable to that length of road.

Consideration shall also be given to cyclists and pedestrians (see Sections 3.10, 4.10 and 5.13 for further details on traffic management regarding pedestrians and cyclists).

When selecting lane widths, especially when travel paths are confined on each side by physical barriers and/or hazards (for example excavations or safety barriers) for a significant distance, it is important to consider any impact of breakdowns and congestion for emergency vehicle access and on traffic flow. Refer to QGTTM Part 2 Section 3.3.4 for more detail.

Where there is a change in speed limit, the minimum lane width requirements may also change with lane widths based on the applicable speed limit at that location. Changes to lane widths will apply at the change in speed limit, with the transition to the new lane width commencing at the speed limit change location. The transition to the new lane width shall occur at a rate which matches the transition rate for a lateral shift (see Table 5.7) of the same distance (the lane width change) in the same location (note the 200 m value for Figure 2.2 applies to taper lengths): for example, for a lane width reduction of 0.4 m, as the lateral shift values are based on a full 3.5 m shift, the equivalent recommended lateral shift distance would be divided by approximately 8.7 (3.5 / 0.4) to establish the taper length required for the 0.4 m transition in lane widths.

As an example, a transition distance for a new speed limit (60 km/h) and lane width (3.0 m), from a 100 km/h zone with an existing 3.5 m lane width, will commence at the 60 km/h sign and transition the 0.5 m change in width over a distance of approximately 15 m, based on a 3.5 m lateral shift at 100 km/h being 100 m long (100 / (3.5 / 0.5) = 14.3).